had joined us a few months ago and the only thing I knew about him was that he had a very positive attitude and was articulate. I cal ed him into my office and did a bit of loud thinking. “Do you have any suggestions?” I then asked him. Babu remained silent for a while, and then asked for time until the next evening to do some homework before answering my question.

The next evening, Babu came to me before the appointed time. His face was beaming with promise. “We can do it, sir! The RATO system can be made without imports. The only hurdle is the inherent inelasticity in the approach of the organization towards procurement and subcontracting, which would be the two major thrust areas to avoid imports.” He gave me seven points, or, rather, asked for seven liberties—financial approval by a single person instead of an entire hierarchy, air travel for al people on work irrespective of their entitlement, accountability to only one person, lifting of goods by air-cargo, sub-contracting to the private sector, placement of orders on the basis of technical competence, and expeditious accounting procedures.

These demands were unheard of in government